

Wife letter

18 Meadow View

Anytown

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15 February 2026

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Michael Thompson

I am writing in support of my husband, Michael Thompson, and his Personal Independence Payment review.

I have lived with Michael for many years and have seen first-hand how his health conditions affect him on a daily basis. Over the last few years I have noticed a gradual decline in both his physical and mental health, and he now relies on me much more than he used to.

Michael suffers from chronic back pain, osteoarthritis in his hands, knees and shoulders, heart problems following a previous heart attack, depression and anxiety. Although he tries his best to remain independent, many everyday tasks have become increasingly difficult for him.

I now do almost all of the cooking because Michael struggles to stand for long periods and has difficulty gripping knives, opening packaging and lifting pans due to pain and weakness in his hands. He often helps where he can, but he usually needs to sit down and rest before a meal is finished.

I am also responsible for organising his medication. I fill a weekly pill organiser and remind him to take his tablets. His hands are painful and stiff, making it difficult for him to handle medication packets, and when his anxiety or depression are particularly bad, he can become forgetful and lose track of whether he has taken his medication.

Getting dressed can be a challenge for Michael. I regularly help him with shirt buttons, socks and shoes because bending causes him pain and his fingers do not work as well as they once did. Simple tasks often take him much longer than they used to.

His mobility has also worsened. Michael uses a walking stick when he leaves the house and walks much more slowly than before. He frequently needs to stop and rest because of pain in his back and knees, as well as breathlessness and chest discomfort. We have to plan outings carefully and allow extra time wherever we go.

One of the biggest changes I have noticed is in his confidence and mental health. Michael has become much more anxious over the last couple of years. He worries about his health and is often concerned about becoming unwell when away from home. He avoids unfamiliar places where possible and is much more comfortable if I accompany him to appointments or outings. He rarely socialises now and spends most of his time at home.

There have also been periods when his depression has been particularly difficult. He has spoken about feeling hopeless at times and has experienced suicidal thoughts in the past. This was very upsetting for both of us. Although he does not currently have any plans to harm himself, I continue to keep a close eye on him and provide emotional support when he is struggling.

Michael takes pride in being as independent as possible and often tries to do more than he realistically can. However, I see the consequences afterwards, as increased activity frequently results in greater pain, fatigue and the need to rest for extended periods.

In my opinion, Michael's health conditions have a significant impact on his daily life. The difficulties he experiences are genuine and have gradually increased over time. He depends on my practical and emotional support much more now than he did a few years ago, and I believe he would struggle to manage many aspects of daily living without assistance.

I hope this information is helpful. Please contact me if any further information is required.

Yours faithfully,

Sarah Thompson

Wife of Michael Thompson